

**Mexican mariachi in traditional dress**

The typical dress worn by charros, similar to American cowboys, is today most frequently worn by mariachi musicians and consists of an ornate suit and *sombrero*.

**Maya woman, Guatemala**

The *huipil* is the most distinctive element of Central American indigenous dress. Some women also wear a *kaperraj* on the head, which doubles as a carrier bag.

BURNOUS Long, hooded *woollen* cloak traditionally worn by North African men; also a women's evening wrap made of *cashmere*.

17TH CENTURY ▷

BUSK A flat piece of *whalebone*, wood, or metal used to stiffen the front of a *corset* or *stays*; wooden busks were often hand-carved and decorated with initials or hearts.

16TH–EARLY 20TH CENTURY

BUSKINS Knee-length boots made of cloth or later of leather, worn for riding or travelling.

14TH CENTURY–LATE 17TH CENTURY



BUSTIER Item of *lingerie* combining a *brassière* and a *camisole*, reaching from the bust to the waist, often with *boning*; see also *Basque*.

1830s–1900s: SEE P.344

BUSTLE Metal frame or padded shapes worn under a woman's dress at the back to support the top of the skirt.

1830s–1900s: SEE PP.200–5, 432–3

BUTCHER'S BOY CAP Wide cap with a deep brim and peak, traditionally worn by tradesmen; also called Baker Boy cap; in the 1960s, worn by men and women.

1960s ▷: SEE PP.382, 428

BUTTON BOOTS Short, lightweight boots fastened up the outside of the ankle with buttons; worn by both men and women.

1890s–EARLY 20TH CENTURY



CABLE KNIT A *knitting* technique in which some stitches are crossed over adjacent ones to create a braided effect; notably used in *Aran knitwear*.

19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.281

CAFTAN see *Kaftan*.

CAGE PETTICOAT Dome-shaped structure used to support a wide skirt, and consisting of *whalebone* or wire hoops joined by bands of tape; see also *Crinoline* and *Petticoat*.

1850s–LATE 1860s: SEE PP.196–7, 432–3

CALICO A finely woven, medium to light *cotton* cloth, with a downy *nap*, originally exported from Calcutta; in the USA, another name for a *toile*.

16TH CENTURY ▷

CAMBRIC A high-quality *linen*.

16TH CENTURY ▷

CAMEL HAIR Undyed hair from camels, or a wool fabric dyed to imitate the colour, usually light beige or tan; used to make coats.

LATE 17TH CENTURY ▷

CAMI-KNICKERS

An item of *lingerie* combining a *camisole* and loose knickers, made of light *cotton* or *silk*.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.252



CAMISOLE An item of *lingerie* that covers the upper body and is held up with thin *spaghetti straps*.

1820s ▷

CAPRI PANTS Close-fitting, mid-calf-length trousers for women.

1950s ▷: SEE P.337

CAPUCHIN A soft hood with a deep cape and a coloured lining; also called a riding hood, it was worn outdoors and for travelling.

16TH–LATE 18TH CENTURY

CARACO A thigh-length women's *jacket*, fitted at the waist or with *box pleats* at the back; some styles were a little longer in the back than in the front.

MID-18TH–EARLY 19TH CENTURY: SEE PP.117, 163

CAR COAT A thigh-length coat worn for travelling; less bulky than the early *automobile coats*.

1940s ▷

CARDIGAN A *knitted jacket* fastened with buttons or a zip, originally worn by soldiers in the Crimean War, but now worn widely by both men and women usually as casual wear.

LATE 19TH CENTURY ▷

CARGO PANTS Loose-fitting trousers with large pockets on the legs, based on trousers worn by US military personnel in World War II; now widely worn as casual wear.

1950s ▷

CARTRIDGE PLEATING Tiny, soft, evenly spaced *pleats* used to gather a large amount of material into an *armscye*, waistband, or *cuff*, without adding bulk to the seam.

MEDIEVAL ▷: SEE PP.145, 452

CASHMERE A fine, soft fabric made from goats' *wool* and originally imported from Kashmir; see also *Pashmina*.

18TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.197

CASSOCK Closed, ankle-length *robe*, with long sleeves and low, *stand-up collar*; usually black; worn by clerics, lay people and choir members of various Christian churches.

13TH CENTURY ▷: SEE P.57

CAT SUIT A close-fitting, stretchy garment for women, combining a zip-up *bodice* and tight trousers.

1960s ▷

CAVALRY TWILL *Worsted* or *rayon twill* with a diagonally ribbed surface; originally used for cavalry in World War I, but now used for men's smart-casual trousers.

1914 ▷

CHAMMER A sleeved gown for men, made from luxury material and worn open at the front.

LATE 14TH–EARLY 19TH CENTURY

CHAMOIS Soft, cream-coloured leather, made from the skin of the Chamois goat or from *sheepskin* or lambskin, used for gloves.

16TH CENTURY ▷